

ANGEL ACTION · RESUSCITATION

CPR — Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation

CPR is performed on anyone who is unresponsive and not breathing normally. Use 30 chest compressions to 2 breaths at 100–120 compressions per minute, adjusting depth and technique for adults, children and infants.

When to start CPR

Start CPR immediately if the person is **unresponsive and not breathing normally**. Don't wait — every minute without CPR reduces survival by about 10%.

Adult and child (over 1 year)

1. Lay the person flat on a firm surface and kneel beside their chest.
2. Place the heel of one hand on the **lower half of the sternum** (centre of the chest). Place your other hand on top and interlock fingers.
3. Keep your arms straight and shoulders directly above your hands.
4. Push down **one third of the depth of the chest** (about 5 cm in an adult).
5. Compress at a rate of **100–120 per minute** — about 2 per second.
6. Give **30 compressions**, then **2 rescue breaths**.
7. Continue 30:2 until the person recovers, an ambulance arrives, an AED instructs you to stop, or you physically cannot continue.

Infant (under 1 year)

1. Place the infant on a firm surface.
2. Use **two fingers** on the lower half of the sternum.
3. Compress one third of chest depth at 100–120 per minute.
4. For breaths, cover **both the mouth and nose** with your mouth and give gentle puffs — just enough to see the chest rise.
5. Continue 30:2.

Compression-only CPR

If you are unable or unwilling to give rescue breaths, do **continuous chest compressions** at 100–120 per minute. Compression-only CPR is much better than no CPR.

When to stop

Stop CPR only if:

- The person starts breathing normally.
- A paramedic or doctor takes over.

- An AED tells you to stand clear (resume immediately if prompted).
- You are physically exhausted and no one can take over.

See also

CPR is step **C** of **DRSABCD**. Apply an **AED** as soon as it arrives — do not stop CPR to wait for it.

*Adapted from **Australian First Aid 5th Edition**. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.*